

XSS Attacks

CompTIA PenTest+ (PT0-003)

Domains:

- 3.0: Vulnerability Discovery and Analysis
- 4.0: Attacks and Exploits

Objectives:

- 3.1: Given a scenario, conduct vulnerability discovery using various techniques.
- 4.5: Given a scenario, perform web application attacks using the appropriate tools.
- 4.10: Given a scenario, use scripting to automate attacks.

Video Overview

This video provides an in-depth look at Cross-Site Scripting (XSS) attacks, a common vulnerability in web applications. As you prepare for your certification, understanding XSS is essential for identifying and mitigating security risks in real-world scenarios. This module will show you how attackers exploit input fields to inject malicious code, demonstrating how these vulnerabilities can lead to data theft and session hijacking. The concepts discussed here directly apply to your future career as a penetration tester, enabling you to secure web applications and protect sensitive information in various professional contexts.

Key Topics Covered

- Cross-Site Scripting (XSS) definition and its prevalence as a web vulnerability
- The role of user input and dynamic HTML content in XSS vulnerabilities
- Reflected XSS: immediate execution via crafted URLs without server-side storage
- Stored XSS: persistent execution from server-saved malicious scripts
- Exploitation of XSS for session stealing, credential theft, and social engineering
- Countermeasures for XSS: input filtering, sanitization, and Web Application Firewalls (WAFs)
- Advanced XSS techniques: polyglots for bypassing security filters

Student Notes Section